

Apple iPhone Air

The Future Hiding in a 5.6mm Frame

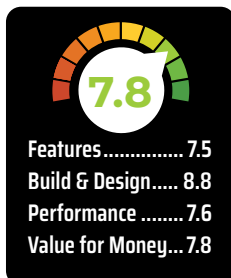
There's a certain magic when you first pick up the iPhone Air. The kind that made the iPhone 4 feel like jewellery in your hand or the iPhone 5S feel like a perfectly balanced tool. It has all the makings of being the spiritual successor to the original 2008 MacBook Air, the one that Steve Jobs famously pulled out of an envelope. The Air is incredibly thin at 5.6mm, yet doesn't feel fragile, more like a precision object you almost want to carry without a case just to show off.

The truth is that no one asked for it. This isn't Apple doing another "Plus" or "Mini" experiment every few years. The Air feels like something else entirely, a provocation, maybe even a rehearsal. Hold it long enough and you start to see the outlines of what's coming: a foldable iPhone, a reimagining of what a pocket computer can be, and the Air as its stepping stone.

And of course, Apple isn't alone here. The Galaxy S25 Edge, Samsung's experiment in thin-and-light titanium, has set the bar earlier this year. But where Samsung plays spec-sheet wars with its oversized numbers and 200MP sensors, Apple's Air is less about how much it can do, and more about whether thinness itself can still feel like progress in 2025.

DESIGN

The iPhone Air is the kind of device that makes you double-take when you set it next to a regular iPhone. If you remember how the iPhone 6 bendgate memes haunted Apple for years, you'll understand why this is almost provocative. At 5.6mm, it doesn't just shave millimetres; it feels like Apple is chiselling the iPhone down to its essence. The titanium frame gives it rigidity, the new Ceramic Shield 2 glass covers both front



and back, and the whole thing weighs just 165g which is lighter than some wallets. You start to realise that every design decision is about space reclamation.

That's why there's no SIM tray anymore. eSIM isn't just a convenience here, it's imperative to the

form factor. Flip the phone over and you'll notice that the raised plateau that holds the camera system isn't just about optics. Apple has tucked silicon and even the speaker into that block, like a mini-penthouse for components. It's clever, but it also means you're down to a single speaker which is a bummer because you don't get the same experience as with a stereo setup.

PERFORMANCE

The iPhone Air might be Apple's thinnest iPhone, but it doesn't behave like a lightweight under the hood. It's powered by the A19 Pro chip with 12GB RAM and NVMe storage which is paired with the N1 wireless chip (Wi-Fi 7 and Bluetooth 6) and the C1X modem for 5G. It posts

benchmark scores that are surprisingly close to the rest of the iPhone 17 family. On AnTuTu, the Air records 2,027,514 points, trailing the Pro Max but not by much. Geekbench shows 3,653 in single-core and 9,365 in multi-core, again only a fraction behind the bigger models.

In 3DMark Wildlife Extreme, the Air manages 3,477 compared to the Pro Max's 5,462, so sustained heavy loads clearly show the limits of a thinner thermal design. But look at shorter burst tests in GFX Bench Metal and the Air actually holds its own: 3,855 frames in Aztec Ruins (high tier), slightly ahead of the Pro Max.

Benchmarks are one thing, but games are the real test. I ran BGMI, Call of Duty Mobile and Genshin Impact, and all of them held a stable 60 FPS without stutter or overheating. The Air does not push for higher refresh rates in these titles the way some Android flagships try to, but stability matters more than chasing frame counts that dip mid-session. The device never became uncomfortably warm in hand, even during longer play, which is a win for such a slim design.

The iPhone 17 lineup ships with iOS 26, and the most noticeable change is the new Liquid Glass interface, which gives iOS a striking, modern look with plenty of customisation. Added handy tools like Live Translation and smarter Visual Intelligence, and continued pushing Apple Intelligence, though it still lags behind Google's Gemini and Samsung's Galaxy AI in accuracy.

BATTERY & CHARGING

This is where the iPhone Air shows its hand. With just a 3,149 mAh cell inside, it carries the smallest battery of any iPhone 17 model. Apple claims up to 27 hours of video playback, which is five hours more than the iPhone 16 managed.

In my usage, the Air consistently delivered around five hours of screen-on time with a normal day of apps, browsing, music and a bit of gaming, enough to get through a workday, but never a phone I'd trust to stretch into the next morning without a charge.